Huddle Decision-led development for teams coding with AI

Your first day with Huddle

You joined a team that works with Claude Code and Huddle. Tasks arrive as Issues with their prompt ready; you start one with a command, answer the AI's questions and decide. This guide sets up your computer once, from zero to your first Issue.

> **The AI writes, tests and asks; you decide.**
> **Your answers to its questions are the work.**

GETTING STARTED

Your first day, step by step

You do this once. It takes 20 to 40 minutes, mostly waiting for downloads. When a step depends on your computer, there is one block for Windows and another for Mac. Your project may add its own steps (its libraries, its test database): they are in the project's `README` and step 7 points you there.

Copy each command from its box, whole and on a single line. If it pastes split in two lines, join it before pressing Enter.

1. Choose how you will use Claude Code

Claude Code works the same in all its versions: the same rules, the same `CLAUDE.md` and the same Huddle plugin. Pick the one you find most comfortable; you can switch later.

DESKTOP APP · THE EASIEST

For people who are starting out. You see the changes visually and can have several sessions side by side. Requires a paid Claude plan.

Install: follow the Windows or Mac download links at `code.claude.com/docs/en/desktop-quickstart`, sign in and open the **Code** tab.

VS CODE EXTENSION

For people who want to read and edit the code in an editor while working with Claude Code.

Install: VS Code from `code.visualstudio.com`; then open the extensions panel (`Ctrl+Shift+X` or `Cmd+Shift+X`), search for **Claude Code** (by Anthropic) and install it. The extension has no terminal command to type for Huddle: you install it with `/plugins` in step 4.

TERMINAL (CLI)

For people who already use the command line. It is also the one that shows Huddle's notice the moment a session opens.

Install: on Windows, in PowerShell:

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

On Mac, in Terminal:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Then type `claude` inside the project folder.

2. Install Git and your platform's command line

Git keeps the code's history. Huddle talks to your platform through its official command line: `gh` for GitHub, `glab` for GitLab. Install the one your project uses.

WINDOWS

1. **Git:** download «Git for Windows» from `git-scm.com` and install it with the default options. It includes **Git Bash**.

2. **GitHub:** open PowerShell and type:

```
winget install --id GitHub.cli
```

3. **GitLab:**

```
winget install --id GLab.GLab
```

4. Close the terminal and open a new one, so it finds the new programs. In VS Code, close every window and open it again.

MAC

1. **Git:** open Terminal and type (two hyphens before `install`):

```
xcode-select --install
```

2. **Homebrew** (the Mac's program installer): follow the one-line instruction at `brew.sh`.
3. **GitHub:**

```
brew install gh
```

GitLab:

```
brew install glab
```

Check: in a new terminal, `gh --version` (or `glab --version`) answers with a version number.

3. Connect your accounts

The repository: accept the invitation that arrives by email. Until you accept it, Huddle cannot assign you Issues.

GitHub: type `gh auth login` and choose GitHub.com, HTTPS and «Login with a web browser».

GitLab: type `glab auth login`, choose gitlab.com (or your company's server) and sign in with the browser. Then let Git use `glab` for gitlab.com, so a Claude

Code session can push without opening a browser:

```
git config --global --add credential.https://gitlab.com.helper "!glab auth git-credential"
```

Claude Code: open it and sign in with the Claude account the AI Manager tells you.

4. Install the Huddle plugin

Huddle comes as a Claude Code plugin. Each person installs it once on their own computer; committing it to the repository does not install it for you. In a terminal (if you use only the VS Code extension, skip these two commands and follow the next paragraph):

```
claude plugin marketplace add SrProfessional/Huddle
```

```
claude plugin install huddle@huddle
```

VS Code extension only: type `/plugins`, add the marketplace `SrProfessional/Huddle` in the **Marketplaces** tab, install `huddle` from the **Plugins** tab with **Install for this project** (not «Install for you»). Each person does this once per clone.

Then open a new Claude Code session. In the CLI you can also type `/plugin marketplace add SrProfessional/Huddle` and `/plugin install huddle@huddle` instead.

Check: `claude plugin list` shows `huddle@huddle` enabled (in the VS Code extension, `/plugins` shows it in the **Plugins** tab). To update it later, in VS Code use the same `/plugins` dialog; otherwise run `claude plugin marketplace update huddle` and `claude plugin update huddle@huddle --scope project` from the project's folder, open a new session, and on a branch run `/huddle-update`: it asks only the questions a new release added.

5. Set your language (a single message)

Issues come in English, so Claude Code would answer in English unless you set your language. Open a session and send this message, replacing `YOUR_LANGUAGE` with your language written in English (for example `spanish` or `portuguese`):

```
Add "language": "YOUR_LANGUAGE" to my personal Claude Code settings file,
~/.claude/settings.json. Keep everything else in that file as it is.
```

It asks for permission to edit the file: accept it. From then on it answers in your language in every session. Commits, PRs and comments stay in English.

6. Download the project and open it

In a terminal, go to the folder where you keep your projects and clone it (the AI Manager gives you its name):

```
gh repo clone OWNER/PROJECT
```

On GitLab: `glab repo clone OWNER/PROJECT`. Then open that folder in the Claude Code you chose. When it asks whether you trust the folder, say yes.

7. Do your project's own setup

Every project has its own libraries and tests. Open its `README` (and its `CLAUDE.md`) and follow the setup section, or ask Claude Code: «read the README and install what the project needs, then run the tests and tell me the results».

8. Check that Huddle sees everything

Ask Claude Code: «run huddle doctor». Every line must show ✓: `plugin`, `huddle.json`, `login`, `ai_manager` and `labels`. If one shows ✕, its line says what to do (for `login`: «not installed or not on the PATH» means `gh` or `glab` is missing from this terminal, and the line gives the install command; «not logged in» means run `gh auth login` or `glab auth login`); if it is not clear, send it to the AI Manager.

9. Take your first Issue

Find the Issue assigned to you (label `assigned`), or type `gh issue list --assignee @me`. In Claude Code type:

```
/huddle-start N
```

with the Issue's number instead of `N`. It checks that the Issue's dependencies are merged, creates your branch in a folder of its own, marks the Issue `in progress` and starts the Issue's prompt. Answer its questions calmly: that is where your work is.

10. When the AI Manager asks for changes

You do not need to watch GitHub. After its closing message the session keeps waiting for the review. When the AI Manager leaves a request, the session tells you and asks whether to continue: say yes. You can also type `/huddle-continue N` yourself, with the Issue's number: `/huddle-start N` only starts an Issue. If you had closed Claude Code, open a new session in the project: Huddle tells you that a request is waiting (in the CLI you see the line at once; in the desktop app and the VS Code panel Claude says it after your first message).

RULES

Five things that are not negotiable

Never push to the default branch, and never merge. Only the AI Manager merges.

Only the Issue's allowed files. If another one is needed, ask first.

No production and no secrets. If a permission or a key is missing, stop and tell the AI Manager.

Nothing is dropped silently. What is not done goes under «What was NOT done» with the reason.

Wait for the closing message. «✅ Issue #N finished» or «⛔ Issue #N stopped» tells you the session is over and what your next step is.

Huddle · decision-led development for teams coding with AI · github.com/SrProfessional/Huddle. The full guide (cycle, roles, labels and rules) is `docs/pdf/huddle-guide.pdf`.